

1 March 2023

To Whom It May Concern:

It is my pleasure to strongly recommend Lena Ayesh for consideration as a candidate for future employment and higher education.

I am [REDACTED], a Senior Analyst with the office of Intelligence Community Net Assessments at the Office of the Director of National Intelligence. I have more than 15 years of experience working on national security and intelligence issues for the U.S. Government, and I have overseen a total of 66 virtual interns for ODNI and senior capstone projects for groups of students at Yale University and Georgetown University. Lena stands out within this group as an exceptionally promising prospect.

When selecting graduate and undergraduate students for ODNI's 2022-2023 Virtual Student Federal Service internship program, I was impressed with Lena and her breadth of diverse and challenging experiences at such an early stage of her collegiate education. I gave this year's virtual interns the task of researching the future of the private sector intelligence marketplace and writing business plans for companies that would be competitive within it. Lena's unique ability to combine data science and international studies provided this year's project with valuable perspectives on topics such as vehicle telematics, cybersecurity, and intelligence. She brought creativity, perspective, and energy to our team through her contributions to the team's market research. She also demonstrated she can conduct solid independent research and collaborate effectively with her project team to ensure they will deliver creative and valuable products to ODNI.

Based on her work in the internship, the project team was able to conduct a several-session futures exercise that identified key issues, trends, drivers, and scenarios that describe how the private sector intelligence marketplace may develop in the next 10-20 years. She played an important role in structuring the team's diverse intelligence research so that it can come together as a final presentation to ODNI seniors later this year. She also set an example by being a dependable participant in our events, including our intelligence speakers' series. I look forward to the benefits her initiative, collaboration, and follow-through will bring to the project's final deliverables, and I hope to see Lena someday choose to become a colleague of mine in the U.S. Intelligence Community.

If you have any questions regarding my recommendation, please do not hesitate to contact me at [REDACTED] or by email at [REDACTED].

Sincerely,

[REDACTED]
Senior Analyst, Intelligence Community Net Assessments
Office of the Director of National Intelligence